GSVFD Firefighter I & II Instructor Guide

Oct 11, 2026

Course overview

This guide gives GSVFD instructors a lesson plan for every task in the Firefighter Taskbook: 17 modules for Firefighter I (about 119 hours) and 7 for Firefighter II (about 49 hours). Each module lists the taskbook tasks and SFFMA skill sheets it prepares the trainee for, so a lesson ends at a K or D sign-off and the trainee is ready for the P sign-off on a later drill.

The content follows NFPA 1010 (2024) Chapters 6 and 7. SFFMA still tests on its NFPA 1001 (2019) sheets, and the taskbook's SFFMA crosswalk maps between them. Hazardous Materials Awareness and Operations (NFPA 470) are taught as a separate course and are not in these hours.

Firefighter I modules

Module	Title	Taskbook tasks	SFFMA FF I sheets	Class hrs	Drill hrs
1	Orientation, safety and health	1.1–1.3, Phase 0	Written	4	0
2	PPE and SCBA	1.4–1.5a, 1.10–1.14	#16, #22, #23	3	9
3	Communications	1.7–1.9	#1, #10	2	2
4	Fire behavior and building construction	LF.1–LF.6	Written	6	0
5	Scene safety, apparatus and references	1.6, 1.15–1.16	#13, #14, #21	2	2
6	Ropes and knots	1.18–1.19	#24	1	3
7	Forcible entry	1.20–1.22	#3	2	4

Module	Title	Taskbook tasks	SFFMA FF I sheets	Class hrs	Drill hrs
8	Ground ladders	1.23–1.25	#4	2	6
9	Hose, nozzles and fire streams	1.26–1.30	#5	3	8
10	Water supply	1.31–1.33	#19	2	6
11	Portable extinguishers	1.34	#2	1	2
12	Search, rescue and firefighter survival	1.9, 1.17, 1.38–1.40	#10, #17	3	8
13	Fire control (live fire)	1.35–1.37, 1.41	#5, #6, #7, #8	4	12
14	Ventilation	1.42–1.43	#18	2	5
15	Overhaul and property conservation	1.47–1.49	#9, #15	2	4
16	Utilities, scene lighting and air monitoring	1.44–1.46	#11, #12, #20	2	3
17	Equipment and hose maintenance	1.50–1.56	#25, #26	1	3
	Firefighter I total			**42**	**77**

Firefighter II modules

Module	Title	Taskbook tasks	SFFMA FF II sheets	Class hrs	Drill hrs
18	Incident management and communications	2.1–2.3	#1, #6	4	2
19	Foam, ignitable liquids and gas cylinders	2.4, 2.7	#2, #3	3	6
20	Coordinating interior attack and thermal imaging	2.5–2.6	#4	3	6
21	Fire cause and evidence protection	2.8	#5	2	2
22	Vehicle extrication and rescue support	2.9–2.11	#12, #13	3	8
23	Fire and life safety and preincident planning	2.12–2.14	#7, #9, #11	3	3
24	Power equipment and hose testing	2.15–2.16	#8, #10	1	3
	Firefighter II total			**19**	**30**

Suggested schedule. Hours are planning estimates for a volunteer department, not NFPA or SFFMA minimums. At one 3-hour drill night a week plus one 8-hour Saturday a month (about 20 hours a month), Firefighter I takes about 6 months and Firefighter II about 3.

1. Modules 1–5 first, in order. They give the trainee safety, PPE, SCBA and radio skills before any hands-on fireground work.
2. Modules 6–12 next, in any order that fits the drill calendar and weather. Put ladders and hose (8–9) before search (12).
3. Module 13 only after every live-fire prerequisite (LF.1–LF.6) is signed in the taskbook.
4. Modules 14–17 can run alongside 13, using the same burn days for ventilation and overhaul practice.
5. Firefighter II starts after the Chief signs the Phase 1 release.

Instructor requirements and training safety

Every drill has a named lead instructor and a named safety officer, and no live-fire evolution runs without the NFPA 1400 roles filled. Anyone on the drill ground can call a safety stop by radio or voice ("STOP, STOP, STOP"), and all activity freezes until the safety officer clears it.

Who may teach and sign

Role	Minimum qualification	Signs in the taskbook
Lead instructor	SFFMA Fire Instructor I (NFPA 1041 content, now consolidated into NFPA 1020) and Firefighter II	K, D and P for any task at or below their certification
Assistant instructor	Firefighter I or higher, current on the skill being taught	K and D
Skill evaluator (P sign-off)	Certified at the level of the task (FF I tasks: FF I; FF II tasks: FF II)	P
Safety officer	Experienced firefighter who is not also instructing that evolution	Signs the drill roster and any safety stop
Live-fire instructor-in-charge	Fire Instructor I or higher, with prior live-fire instruction experience	Live-fire log entries

Live-fire evolutions (NFPA 1400, carried from NFPA 1403)

- Every trainee has LF.1–LF.6 signed in the taskbook before the burn day.

- Fill the instructor-in-charge, safety officer and ignition officer roles with different people.
- Keep one instructor for every five trainees (the 1403 ratio; confirm against the 1400 text the department adopts).
- Supply attack lines and backup lines from separate water sources, and flow-test both before ignition.
- Have a BLS ambulance on scene, a rapid intervention crew staged, and a written emergency plan.
- Walk every participant through the structure or prop before the first ignition.
- Use only Class A fuels or a listed gas-fired prop, never ignitable liquids in a structure.

Every drill

- Brief at the start: objectives, hazards, safety officer, rehab location and emergency procedure.
- Run rehab per NFPA 1580: water, shade or cooling, and vitals checks after each SCBA bottle or every 45 minutes of work. Set a department heat-index limit for summer drills.
- Use manikins, never live people, for drags, carries and ladder rescues.
- After any smoke or fire exposure, do on-scene gross decon, bag gear, and shower within an hour.
- Report every injury or near miss that day on the department form and note it in the drill record.

How to run a lesson

Every module runs the same way: a short classroom lecture from the slide deck, then hands-on drill stations, then sign-offs. Lectures stay under 50 minutes before a break or a move to the drill ground; trainees learn these skills by doing them.

What each lesson plan contains

- **Tasks and sheets** — the taskbook tasks and SFFMA skill sheets the module prepares for.
- **Time** — classroom and drill hours.
- **Objectives** — what the trainee can explain or do at the end.
- **Materials** — props, tools and PPE to stage before the drill.
- **Lecture outline** — key points in teaching order; the matching slide deck carries the same order.

- **Drill stations** — hands-on stations with the steps to coach.
- **Evaluation** — what an evaluator watches for at the P sign-off, and the errors trainees commonly make.
- **Instructor notes** — GSVFD-specific points, safety cautions and local equipment.

Teaching a skill: explain, demonstrate, imitate, practice

1. **Explain** why the skill matters and when it is used, in one or two minutes.
2. **Demonstrate** the whole skill at working speed, then again slowly, naming each step.
3. **Imitate**: each trainee performs it step by step while the instructor coaches and corrects on the spot.
4. **Practice**: trainees repeat it until it is correct without prompting, then under realistic conditions (gloves, SCBA, obscured mask, time pressure).

Running drill stations

- Keep about one instructor for every four trainees at a skill station, and one for every five on a live-fire evolution.
- Rotate stations every 20–30 minutes so trainees stay hands-on rather than watching.
- Put SCBA-heavy stations next to rehab and limit each trainee to two bottles before a full rehab break.
- End each drill with a 5-minute debrief: what went well, what to fix, and who is ready for which sign-off.

From lesson to certification

1. Lecture and discussion → instructor signs **K** in the taskbook.
2. Demonstration and coached practice → instructor signs **D**.
3. Unaided performance on a later drill day, to the JPR standard → a certified evaluator signs **P**.
4. All tasks at P → the training officer uploads training records to the SFFMA Portal, and the trainee takes the SFFMA written and skills exams.

Firefighter I — Modules 1–4

Module 1 — Orientation, safety and health

Tasks: 1.1–1.3 and Phase 0 orientation · **SFFMA:** written exam · **Time:** 4 hr class

Objectives. The trainee can describe GSVFD's organization, chain of command, mission and SOPs, and the Firefighter I role. They can explain the 16 Firefighter Life Safety Initiatives, the two-in / two-out rule, the leading causes of firefighter deaths and injuries, cancer-reduction practices, signs of behavioral distress and how to reach help.

Materials. Department SOPs and bylaws, organization chart, district and mutual-aid map, Module 1 slides.

Lecture outline

1. The fire service mission and GSVFD's history, district and mutual-aid partners.
2. Organization, chain of command, and who a probationary member reports to on scene.
3. SOPs, rules, and where they are kept.
4. Standards that shape the job: NFPA 1010, 1550, 1580, 1850 and OSHA respiratory rules.
5. Why firefighters die: sudden cardiac events and vehicle crashes lead most years; fireground deaths follow.
6. The 16 Life Safety Initiatives and the risk rule — risk a lot only to save savable lives.
7. Two-in / two-out and personnel accountability.
8. Cancer and contamination: gross decon, clean gear, shower, clean cab.
9. Behavioral health: warning signs in yourself and others; peer support and the member assistance program.
10. Fitness, sleep and nutrition as job skills.

Drill. None; pair this with the Phase 0 station tour and apparatus walk-around.

Evaluation. A 10-question quiz at 70% to pass, then K sign-offs for 1.1–1.3. Common gaps: trainees cannot name who they report to, or confuse two-in / two-out with RIT.

Instructor notes. Have the Chief or a senior officer open this module. Give every trainee the member assistance contact in writing.

Module 2 — PPE and SCBA

Tasks: 1.4, 1.5, 1.5a, 1.10–1.14 · **SFFMA:** FF I #16, #22, #23 · **Time:** 3 hr class, 9 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can name each part of structural PPE and its limits, inspect gear and decide whether it needs cleaning, repair or replacement, and don and doff without contamination. They can name respiratory hazards, inspect and don SCBA by each department method, breathe in a controlled way, manage air, perform emergency procedures, change cylinders, and pass a restricted opening.

Materials. A full PPE set and SCBA per trainee, spare cylinders, a blackout facepiece cover, a restricted-passage prop or stud wall, timer, PPE inspection checklist.

Lecture outline

1. Structural ensemble parts and how each protects (NFPA 1970); where the ensemble fails — heat stress, steam burns, and contamination.
2. Inspection, routine and advanced cleaning, and retirement (NFPA 1850).
3. Respiratory hazards: low oxygen, heat, smoke particulates, and toxic gases such as carbon monoxide and hydrogen cyanide.
4. SCBA parts: backplate and harness, cylinder, regulator, facepiece, PASS and low-air alarm.
5. Daily check: cylinder full, PASS works, alarms sound, facepiece seals.
6. Donning methods: over the head, coat style, and seat-mounted.
7. Air management: controlled breathing and leaving the hazard before the low-air alarm.
8. Emergency procedures: regulator failure, facepiece damage, low or no air — and why the facepiece stays on.
9. Restricted passages: reduced profile, then loosen straps; never remove the facepiece.
10. Doffing with contamination control and preparing gear for reuse.

Drill stations

- **A. PPE:** don and doff to the 60-second GSVFD standard; inspect a set using the checklist (1.5a).
- **B. SCBA donning:** each method, ending on air with PASS armed and no skin exposed.
- **C. Cylinder change:** self and partner, by feel, eyes closed.
- **D. SCBA confidence:** blackout facepiece, crawl course, restricted-passage prop.
- **E. Emergency procedures:** simulated regulator failure and low-air alarm, called as a Mayday.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for: hood not covering the facepiece edge, exposed wrists or neck, PASS not armed, cylinder not checked full, breath-holding, and reaching for the facepiece in the restricted passage. Any of these fails the P sign-off.

Instructor notes. No trainee wears SCBA until the fit test (Phase 0, item 0.13) is on file. Keep the confidence course dry and cool; heat comes later in live fire.

Module 3 — Communications

Tasks: 1.7, 1.8, 1.8a, 1.9 · **SFFMA:** FF I #1, #10 · **Time:** 2 hr class, 2 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can take a report of an emergency and relay it to dispatch, operate a portable and mobile radio on the right channel, tell routine from emergency traffic, answer the station phone, and transmit a Mayday.

Materials. Portable radios on a training channel, the department radio SOP and channel plan, station phone or a stand-in, scenario cards.

Lecture outline

1. How a call reaches GSVFD: caller, dispatch, page-out, response.
2. What dispatch needs: address, nature, callback number, hazards and number of patients.
3. Radio parts and controls; channels and talk groups.
4. Good transmissions: think, key, pause, talk; plain language; who you are calling, then who you are.
5. Routine traffic, emergency traffic, and the evacuation signal.
6. Mayday: when to call it (lost, trapped, out of air, injured), the LUNAR report, the emergency button and PASS.
7. Taking a phone message at the station.

Drill stations

- **A. Report and relay:** a trainee takes a scripted 911-style report and relays it to a mock dispatcher.
- **B. Radio traffic:** a progress report, a resource request and an evacuation order across the drill ground.
- **C. Mayday:** a trainee in a blackout facepiece calls a Mayday within 30 seconds of being told they are lost.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for keying and talking at once (cutting off the first word), wrong channel, long rambling transmissions, and hesitating to call the Mayday.

Instructor notes. Insert the GSVFD channel plan and dispatch center name before the lesson.

Module 4 — Fire behavior and building construction

Tasks: live-fire prerequisites LF.1–LF.6 (knowledge) · **SFFMA:** written exam · **Time:** 6 hr class

Objectives. The trainee can explain combustion and the fire tetrahedron, the three forms of heat transfer, the stages of fire development, fuel- versus ventilation-limited fire, flashover, backdraft and smoke explosion, flow path, and how to read smoke. They can name the five building construction types, collapse warning signs, and door-control and gas-cooling techniques.

Materials. Module 4 slides, smoke-reading videos, construction samples (truss, I-joist, gusset plate) if available.

Lecture outline

1. Combustion basics: fuel, heat, oxygen and the chemical chain reaction; states of fuel.
2. Heat transfer: conduction, convection and radiation.
3. Stages: incipient, growth, fully developed, decay.
4. Fuel-limited versus ventilation-limited fire, and why modern furnishings reach flashover far faster than legacy ones.
5. Hazards: flashover, rollover, backdraft and smoke explosion, with the warning signs of each.
6. Flow path, neutral plane and why opening a door or window feeds the fire.
7. Reading smoke: volume, velocity, density and color.
8. Construction types I–V and the rural buildings common in the district (pole barns, manufactured homes, metal buildings).
9. Lightweight construction and collapse indicators.
10. Door control, cooling hot gases, and direct, indirect and combination attack.

Evaluation. A 25-question written test at 70% to pass, then K sign-offs for LF.3–LF.6. This module must be complete before any live-fire evolution.

Instructor notes. Use UL FSRI's free online training and videos for flow path and modern-fuel content.

Firefighter I — Modules 5–9

Module 5 — Scene safety, apparatus and references

Tasks: 1.6, 1.15, 1.16 · **SFFMA:** FF I #13, #14, #21 · **Time:** 2 hr class, 2 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can mount, ride and dismount apparatus safely, set up a protected work area at a roadway or structure scene, recognize scene hazards common in the district, and find answers in the SOPs and the Emergency Response Guidebook

(ERG).

Materials. An engine, cones or flares, high-visibility vests, the current ERG, department SOP binder or app.

Lecture outline

1. Riding rules: seated and belted before the wheels move; no standing or riding outside the cab; hearing protection.
2. Dismounting: face the apparatus, three points of contact, and exit away from traffic.
3. Traffic incident management: block with the apparatus, set cones upstream, wear a vest outside the hot zone, never turn your back to traffic.
4. Downed wires: treat every wire as energized; stay well clear and wait for the utility.
5. Solar panels: they make power whenever light hits them, even after the main is off.
6. Battery storage and EV batteries: thermal runaway, reignition, and toxic gases.
7. Rural hazards: gas well pads, pipelines and pump jacks, livestock, rough terrain.
8. Finding information: SOP index, ERG color sections, and the department contact list.

Drill stations

- **A. Apparatus:** mount, belt in, don seat-mounted SCBA if the department rides with it, dismount on the curb side.
- **B. Highway scene:** block a lane with the engine and set a cone taper; trainees work only inside it.
- **C. Reference race:** look up a UN number in the ERG and a policy in the SOPs within a set time.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for unbuckling before the apparatus stops, stepping out on the traffic side, and working outside the cone taper.

Instructor notes. Name the district's specific hazards here: gas wells, pipelines and major roads.

Module 6 — Ropes and knots

Tasks: 1.18–1.19 · **SFFMA:** FF I #24 · **Time:** 1 hr class, 3 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can tell life-safety rope from utility rope, inspect rope and take it out of service, tie the required knots wearing gloves, and hoist each listed tool with the correct knot.

Materials. Utility rope, a hoisting point (tower, balcony or second floor), axe, pike pole, short ladder, dry and charged hoseline, fan, rope log.

Lecture outline

1. Rope types and materials; life-safety rope is for people only and follows NFPA 2500.
2. Inspection, cleaning, storage, the rope log, and when rope goes out of service.
3. Knots: clove hitch, figure-8, figure-8 on a bight, bowline, half hitch, safety (overhand) knot.
4. Hoisting each tool: axe and pike pole, ladder, dry hoseline, charged hoseline with the nozzle closed, fan.
5. Tag lines and the "rope" warning call before lowering.

Drill stations

- **A. Knot board:** every knot, gloved, then eyes closed.
- **B. Hoisting:** each tool raised and lowered from the hoisting point with a tag line.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for a missing safety knot, a hitch tied on the wrong end of the tool, and a charged line hoisted with the nozzle open.

Module 7 — Forcible entry

Tasks: 1.20–1.22 · **SFFMA:** FF I #3 · **Time:** 2 hr class, 4 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can size up a door, window or wall, choose the right tool, force entry while keeping control of the door, and leave the opening safe.

Materials. Irons (flat-head axe and Halligan), K-tool or through-the-lock kit, bolt cutters, a rotary saw with metal and masonry blades, a forcible-entry door prop, padlocks, a window prop, a breach-wall prop, eye protection.

Lecture outline

1. Try before you pry: check that the door is not already open.
2. Tool families: striking, prying, cutting, pushing and pulling.
3. Doors: inward- versus outward-swinging, wood versus metal frames, and how to tell.
4. Inward door: gap, set, force. Outward door: gap the hinge or lock side and pry out.
5. Door control: a strap or rope on the knob so the door can be closed if conditions change.
6. Windows: break from the upwind side with hands above the glass, clear the whole sash.

7. Padlocks and gates: cut the shackle, or remove the hasp.
8. Walls: breach between studs, check for wires and pipes first.
9. Saw safety: eye and hearing protection, a fire watch, and controlling sparks.

Drill stations

- **A. Door prop:** inward and outward doors with irons, two-person team.
- **B. Locks:** padlocks and through-the-lock.
- **C. Windows and walls:** clear a window; breach a stud wall.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for no door control, swinging tools without checking the swing area, and leaving glass in the frame.

Module 8 — Ground ladders

Tasks: 1.23–1.25 · **SFFMA:** FF I #4 · **Time:** 2 hr class, 6 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can name ladder parts and types, carry and raise single, roof and extension ladders alone and with a partner, set the correct angle and tip placement, climb and work from a ladder, and inspect it afterward.

Materials. Every ladder carried on GSVFD apparatus, a two-story training wall, a leg-lock area, an inspection checklist.

Lecture outline

1. Parts: beams, rungs, butt, tip, fly, bed section, halyard, dogs, heat sensor label.
2. Types: single (wall), roof, extension, folding (attic).
3. Selecting the length: a second-story window usually needs a 24-ft ladder; the roof line, 28 ft or more.
4. Hazards: overhead wires (keep at least 10 ft away), soft or sloped ground, doorways.
5. Carries and raises: one-firefighter and two-firefighter.
6. Angle: about 75 degrees — the base sits one-quarter of the working length out from the wall.
7. Tip placement: rescue at the sill; ventilation beside the window; roof access several rungs above the edge.
8. Climbing: smooth, hands on rungs, three points of contact; leg lock or ladder belt to work.
9. Inspection and cleaning after use.

Drill stations

- **A. Carries and raises:** each ladder, each method, to window and roof positions.
- **B. Climb and work:** climb, apply a leg lock, pass a tool, dismount onto a roof and back.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for not checking overhead first, dogs not locked, the halyard not tied off, and a tip placed against glass or gutter.

Instructor notes. Foot every ladder during training, and run the first raises with no SCBA, then add it.

Module 9 — Hose, nozzles and fire streams

Tasks: 1.26–1.30 · **SFFMA:** FF I #5 (hose parts) · **Time:** 3 hr class, 8 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can name hose sizes, couplings and appliances; load, carry, advance and extend attack lines; operate smooth-bore and fog nozzles without water hammer; replace a burst section; and operate a line from a ladder.

Materials. An engine with charged attack lines, spare hose sections, wye, double-male and double-female, reducers, hose straps and clamps, stairs and a ladder for advances.

Lecture outline

1. Hose sizes and uses on GSVFD apparatus: attack lines, supply lines, booster and forestry lines.
2. Couplings: threaded and Storz; caring for threads and gaskets.
3. Appliances: wye, siamese, adapters, reducers, hose clamps.
4. Loads and finishes: flat, accordion, minuteman, triple-layer preconnects.
5. Carries and advances: shoulder loads, flaking at the door, stairs, ladders.
6. Nozzles: smooth-bore and combination (fog); straight stream, narrow fog and wide fog.
7. Nozzle reaction and body position; why the backup firefighter matters.
8. Water hammer: open and close slowly.
9. Burst lengths: clamp or kink, replace, restore flow.

Drill stations

- **A. Loads:** reload each preconnect after deployment.
- **B. Advances:** charged line up and down stairs, over a ladder, around corners.
- **C. Nozzle work:** patterns, pencil and sweep, slow shutdown.
- **D. Burst section:** replace on the clock as a two-person team.
- **E. Ladder line:** secure a charged line to a ground ladder with a hose strap and operate it.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for slamming the bale shut, kinks left at the door, and the nozzle firefighter advancing without a backup.

Firefighter I — Modules 10–13

Module 10 — Water supply

Tasks: 1.31–1.33 · **SFFMA:** FF I #19 · **Time:** 2 hr class, 6 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can connect an engine to a hydrant on a forward or reverse lay, hand lay a supply line, set up a portable tank and draft from it, and explain how a tanker shuttle keeps water flowing where there are no hydrants.

Materials. Engine, tanker, portable (drop) tank, hard suction with strainer, jet siphon or transfer equipment, supply hose, hydrant wrench and spanners, a hydrant or static source.

Lecture outline

1. Why rural water supply decides most GSVFD structure fires.
2. Hydrants: types, outlets, opening fully and slowly, closing slowly. Get the water supplier's permission before training flows.
3. Forward lay (hydrant to fire) and reverse lay (fire to hydrant).
4. Static sources: ponds, stock tanks, dry hydrants; drafting basics and the strainer.
5. Portable tanks: site selection, ground tarp, opening the frame, approach and dump.
6. Tanker shuttle: fill site, dump site, traffic pattern, and moving water between tanks.
7. Hard suction care and tight connections.

Drill stations

- **A. Hydrant:** forward and reverse lay, connect and charge.
- **B. Hand lay:** short supply line to the engine intake.
- **C. Dump site:** deploy the drop tank, dump the tanker, place the hard suction and strainer, transfer between tanks.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for opening the hydrant too fast, kinks at the intake, the strainer resting on the tank bottom, and standing between the tanker and the tank during the dump.

Instructor notes. Run at least one full tanker-shuttle drill with a mutual-aid tanker each year.

Module 11 — Portable extinguishers

Tasks: 1.34 · **SFFMA:** FF I #2 · **Time:** 1 hr class, 2 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can name fire classes A, B, C, D and K, read extinguisher labels and ratings, choose the right extinguisher, and put out incipient Class A, B and C fires using a safe approach.

Materials. Pressurized water, ABC dry chemical, and CO2 extinguishers; a Class A fuel pan, a Class B pan of at least 9 sq ft or a listed simulator, a simulated energized Class C item.

Lecture outline

1. Fire classes and the extinguishing agents for each.
2. Labels, pictographs and ratings.
3. Limits: short discharge time, reach, and reflash.
4. PASS: pull, aim, squeeze, sweep; approach upwind, back away facing the fire.
5. Monthly inspection: gauge, pin and seal, hose, tag.

Drill. One extinguishment per class, rotating extinguisher types.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for aiming at flames instead of the base, turning their back on the fire, and using water on a Class C fire.

Module 12 — Search, rescue and firefighter survival

Tasks: 1.9, 1.17, 1.38–1.40 · **SFFMA:** FF I #10, #17 · **Time:** 3 hr class, 8 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can perform primary and secondary searches as a team, judge tenability, remove a victim by drag, carry and ladder, rescue a downed firefighter whose SCBA is working or has failed, exit a hazardous area following a hoseline, and call a Mayday when lost or trapped.

Materials. A search maze or darkened building, manikins (adult and firefighter), a hoseline with couplings, blackout facepieces, ladders, a drag rescue device or SCBA-strap drag method.

Lecture outline

1. Search priorities: most-threatened victims first, then the rest of the structure.
2. Primary (fast) versus secondary (thorough) search.
3. Oriented search and wall search; staying on a wall or hoseline.
4. Tenability: heat, visibility, and when to back out.

5. Victim removal: drags, carries, and ladder rescue.
6. Firefighter rescue: converting the SCBA harness into a drag, keeping a failed SCBA's facepiece on, and getting RIT air if equipped.
7. Self-survival: following a hoseline out (the female coupling end faces the engine; the male end faces the nozzle), entanglement, wall breach, and finding a safe haven.
8. Mayday and the rapid intervention crew.

Drill stations

- **A. Search:** two-person primary search of a darkened building with a manikin.
- **B. Victim removal:** drags, a two-person carry, and a ladder rescue with a manikin.
- **C. Downed firefighter:** drag with working SCBA; drag with failed SCBA.
- **D. Survival:** lost on a hoseline with a blackout facepiece, read couplings, exit, and call a Mayday.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for losing partner contact, skipping rooms, standing upright in heat, and waiting too long to call the Mayday.

Module 13 — Fire control (live fire)

Tasks: 1.35–1.37, 1.41 · **SFFMA:** FF I #5 and #6 (live fire required), #7 (live fire optional), #8 (simulated) · **Time:** 4 hr class, 12 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can extinguish exterior Class A fires, attack a passenger vehicle fire, fight a ground cover fire, and attack an interior structure fire at, above and below grade as a team member.

Materials. A live-fire facility or approved acquired structure, Class A fuel per NFPA 1400, a vehicle prop or burnable vehicle, an exterior burn container, a brush truck and wildland PPE, a full staffing plan.

Lecture outline

1. Exterior Class A fires: reach, penetration, breaking up material, protecting exposures, and preserving origin signs.
2. Vehicle fires: approach from the side at an angle, upwind and uphill; bumpers, struts and airbags as hazards; alternative fuels; electric vehicles need large amounts of water and can reignite.
3. Ground cover fires: head, flanks and rear; anchor and flank; LCES (lookouts, communications, escape routes, safety zones); fire line with hand tools.
4. Interior attack team roles: nozzle, backup, door.

5. Size-up at the door: smoke, heat, flow path.
6. Door control and cooling hot gases before advancing.
7. Direct, indirect and combination attack.
8. Fires above grade (stairs, ladders) and below grade (basements: heat, collapse).
9. Finding hidden fire in walls and floors.

Drill stations (all live fire run to NFPA 1400)

- **A. Exterior container** (dumpster or pile).
- **B. Vehicle fire** (prop or vehicle).
- **C. Ground cover:** simulated with hand tools and a brush truck line.
- **D. Interior attack:** grade level with a burst-section replacement, above grade up a ladder or stairs, below grade down an interior stair.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for opening the nozzle on smoke without reading conditions, losing door control, standing upright in heat, and leaving the vehicle's compartments unopened.

Instructor notes. Check LF.1–LF.6 in every trainee's taskbook before the burn. Record each evolution in the taskbook's live-fire log.

Firefighter I — Modules 14–17

Module 14 — Ventilation

Tasks: 1.42–1.43 · **SFFMA:** FF I #18 · **Time:** 2 hr class, 5 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can explain why ventilation must be coordinated with fire attack, perform horizontal ventilation by natural, mechanical and hydraulic methods, and perform vertical ventilation on a roof prop from a secured roof ladder.

Materials. A positive-pressure fan, smoke machine or smoke building, roof prop (pitched and flat if available), roof ladder, extension ladder, axe, pike pole, rotary or chain saw, fog nozzle line.

Lecture outline

1. Ventilation changes the fire: added air speeds fire growth unless water is applied.
2. Ventilate only on order, with an attack line in place.
3. Horizontal: natural (windows and doors, using wind), mechanical (positive and negative pressure), and hydraulic (fog stream out a window).

4. Positive pressure: an exhaust opening first, fan placed to seal the doorway, and never into a fire without an attack line.
5. Vertical: when it helps; roof types common in the district, including metal roofs.
6. Roof safety: sound the roof, work from a roof ladder, keep an escape route, stay upwind.
7. Cutting and opening a vent hole; louvering; trench cuts (awareness only).
8. Signs of roof collapse: sagging, sponginess, fire through the roof, and lightweight truss construction.

Drill stations

- **A. Horizontal:** clear a window safely; set up and run a positive-pressure fan on a smoke building.
- **B. Hydraulic:** ventilate a room with a fog stream.
- **C. Vertical:** raise and secure ladders, hoist tools, sound, cut and clear an opening on the roof prop.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for venting before the line is ready, the fan blowing without an exhaust opening, and walking on the roof without sounding it.

Instructor notes. Saw operators wear eye, hearing and full PPE; keep a second firefighter as spotter.

Module 15 — Overhaul and property conservation

Tasks: 1.47–1.49 · **SFFMA:** FF I #9, #15 · **Time:** 2 hr class, 4 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can overhaul a fire scene without weakening the structure, find and extinguish hidden fire, preserve evidence, protect property with salvage covers, water chutes and catch-alls, cover building openings, and stop sprinkler flow.

Materials. Overhaul prop or burned room, pike poles, axes, salvage covers, plastic sheeting, sprinkler wedges and stoppers, a sprinkler riser or valve prop.

Lecture outline

1. Overhaul begins after the fire is controlled; SCBA stays on, because carbon monoxide and toxic particulates remain.
2. Where fire hides: walls, ceilings, voids, attics, around outlets and light fixtures.
3. Pulling ceilings: stand between the hole and the exit; start near the walls.
4. Limiting water damage: small flows and targeted application.

5. Recognizing possible origin and cause; stop and tell the officer before moving anything.
6. Property conservation: why it matters to the public; cluster furniture and cover it; chutes and catch-alls.
7. Covering roof, window and door openings after the fire.
8. Sprinklers: stop a head with a wedge or stopper; find and close the main control valve.

Drill stations

- **A. Overhaul:** open a wall and ceiling on a prop and check for hidden fire.
- **B. Salvage:** cluster and cover furniture, build a water chute and a catch-all, fold covers for reuse.
- **C. Sprinklers:** stop a flowing head; operate the main control valve.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for removing SCBA during overhaul, throwing debris out before the origin is checked, and leaving the sprinkler valve closed without reporting it.

Module 16 — Utilities, scene lighting and air monitoring

Tasks: 1.44–1.46 · **SFFMA:** FF I #11, #12, #20 · **Time:** 2 hr class, 3 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can safely shut off electric, natural gas, propane and water service; set up and run scene lighting within the manufacturer's limits; and operate the department's gas monitor, recognize its alarms and act on them.

Materials. Utility prop (electric panel, gas meter, water meter), propane tank valve or prop, generator, lights, cords, GFCI devices, the department gas monitor and bump-test gas.

Lecture outline

1. Electric: shut off at the main breaker or disconnect; never pull a meter unless SOPs allow it.
2. Natural gas: quarter-turn the meter valve so the tang crosses the pipe; leave relighting to the utility.
3. Propane, common in rural homes: close the tank valve clockwise; beware a leaking or heated tank.
4. Water: curb stop or main valve.
5. Scene lighting: generator placement away from exhaust paths, cord routing, GFCI resets, aiming lights away from drivers' eyes.

6. Gas monitors: what each sensor detects (oxygen, flammable gas as % of the lower explosive limit, carbon monoxide, and often hydrogen sulfide).
7. Starting a monitor: fresh-air zero, bump test, and the alarm set points on GSVFD's model.
8. When it alarms: back out, warn others, report the reading, ventilate if ordered.

Drill stations

- **A. Utilities:** shut off each utility on the prop and report.
- **B. Lighting:** light a mock scene at night.
- **C. Monitor:** start, bump-test and use the monitor on scenario readings.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for operating the gas valve the wrong way, overloading the generator, and silencing a monitor alarm without acting on it.

Instructor notes. Insert the department monitor's make, sensors and alarm set points before teaching.

Module 17 — Equipment and hose maintenance

Tasks: 1.50–1.56 · **SFFMA:** FF I #25, #26 · **Time:** 1 hr class, 3 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can clean and check ladders, SCBA, rope, hand tools, ventilation equipment and salvage covers; wash, inspect and reload hose; complete apparatus check sheets; and clean structural PPE after a fire.

Materials. Cleaning supplies, SCBA check sheets, ladder and rope logs, hose washer or brushes, spare gaskets, truck check sheets.

Lecture outline

1. Why readiness matters: equipment fails on calls if it is not checked after drills and calls.
2. SCBA daily or weekly checks and cleaning per NFPA 1850 and the manufacturer.
3. Ladders: clean, inspect, and remove from service if the heat sensor has changed or damage is found.
4. Rope: inspect, wash, dry, log.
5. Hand tools: clean, check heads and handles, light oil on metal.
6. Hose: wash, dry, inspect couplings and gaskets, mark defects, reload.
7. PPE: routine cleaning after fire exposure; advanced cleaning by the department process.
8. Records and reporting defects.

Drill. A post-drill or post-call reset where each trainee restores one apparatus to service under supervision.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for loading wet hose, missed records, and equipment returned to service with a defect not reported.

Instructor notes. Use every real call as practice for 1.55 and 1.56.

Firefighter II — Modules 18–21

Module 18 — Incident management and communications

Tasks: 2.1–2.3 · **SFFMA:** FF II #1, #6 · **Time:** 4 hr class, 2 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can decide when command is needed, establish command with an initial radio report, run the incident until an officer arrives, transfer command face to face, work in an assigned ICS role, request more resources, and complete a basic incident report.

Materials. ICS-100 and ICS-200 certificates on file, a tabletop or magnetic command board, radios, scenario cards, the department incident report system.

Lecture outline

1. NIMS and ICS basics: command, operations, planning, logistics and finance; span of control of three to seven, ideally five.
2. When a Firefighter II takes command: first on scene with no officer.
3. The initial radio report: unit, address, what you see, what you are doing, and command name.
4. Command modes: investigating, fast attack, and command post.
5. Transferring command face to face, with a briefing on conditions, actions and needs.
6. Working in an assigned role: division, group, or water supply.
7. Requesting help: a second alarm, mutual aid, tankers, extrication tools, or rehab.
8. Incident reports: why accuracy matters, what goes in a report, codes, and proofreading.

Drill stations

- **A. Command:** trainee arrives first at a tabletop structure fire, gives the initial report, assigns arriving units, then transfers command.

- **B. Resource requests:** request mutual aid at a large grass fire and extrication tools at a crash, by radio.
- **C. Report:** complete an incident report from a scenario.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for no command name, vague resource requests, and forgetting to transfer command when an officer arrives.

Module 19 — Foam, ignitable liquids and gas cylinders

Tasks: 2.4, 2.7 · **SFFMA:** FF II #2 (live fire or gas prop), #3 · **Time:** 3 hr class, 6 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can choose the right foam for hydrocarbon and polar-solvent fuels, set up a proportioning system, apply foam to build and keep a blanket, and control a flammable gas cylinder fire as part of a two-line team.

Materials. Engine, inline eductor and matched nozzle, Class A and Class B (or training) foam concentrate, a burn pan or gas-fired prop, propane cylinder prop, two attack lines.

Lecture outline

1. How foam works: smothering, separating, cooling, and suppressing vapors.
2. Class A versus Class B foam; alcohol-resistant concentrates for polar solvents such as ethanol blends.
3. Fluorinated foams and PFAS health concerns; the move to fluorine-free foams and contamination control.
4. Proportioning: eductor and nozzle flows must match; limits on hose length and elevation; common causes of poor foam.
5. Application: roll-on, bank-down and rain-down; never plunge foam into the fuel.
6. Approach and retreat facing the hazard; keep the blanket intact.
7. Pressurized gas: propane cylinders and rural tanks, relief valves, BLEVE warning signs.
8. Cylinder fire tactics: two fog lines, approach from the side rather than the ends, cool the vapor space, close the valve, and never extinguish the flame until the gas is shut off.

Drill stations

- **A. Foam setup:** assemble eductor, hose and nozzle; produce finished foam.
- **B. Ignitable liquid fire:** extinguish a pan or prop fire with foam and retreat as a team.
- **C. Gas cylinder:** two-line approach, close the valve under the fog curtain, cool and back out.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for mismatched eductor and nozzle, plunging foam into the pan, turning backs on the hazard, and extinguishing a gas fire before shutting off the fuel.

Instructor notes. Use training foam where possible and contain the runoff.

Module 20 — Coordinating interior attack and thermal imaging

Tasks: 2.5–2.6 · **SFFMA:** FF II #4 (thermal imager not yet tested by SFFMA) · **Time:** 3 hr class, 6 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can lead an attack line team: choose the attack method for a fire in an attic, at grade, on an upper floor or in a basement; coordinate with search and ventilation; read changing conditions and building hazards; and keep command informed. They can also use a thermal imager to find victims, hot spots and the liquid level in a container.

Materials. Burn building or acquired structure, two attack lines, thermal imagers, sealed containers partially filled with water for level checks.

Lecture outline

1. The Firefighter II as attack-line leader: crew integrity, assignments, and communication.
2. Choosing the hose, nozzle and attack for the fire's location.
3. Coordinating with ventilation and search, with flow path in mind.
4. Progress reports: conditions, actions and needs.
5. How fire affects building materials: wood, steel, masonry, concrete, gypsum, glass, and plaster on lath.
6. Collapse warning signs and when to pull the crew out.
7. Thermal imagers: what they detect, display modes and colors, and what they cannot see through (glass, water, walls).
8. Using a thermal imager for search, fire location, overhaul and container levels; never let it replace crawling and feeling.

Drill stations

- **A. Lead the line:** trainee leads a two-person crew through a live or simulated attack and reports to command.
- **B. Thermal imager:** find a hidden manikin, a hot spot behind a wall, and the liquid line in a container.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for advancing without checking conditions, no report to command, and a crew that walks upright because the thermal imager "shows it's clear".

Module 21 — Fire cause and evidence protection

Tasks: 2.8 · **SFFMA:** FF II #5 · **Time:** 2 hr class, 2 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can find the probable origin area, recognize possible causes, and protect evidence until an investigator arrives.

Materials. Burned room or a staged origin scenario, flashlights, scene tape, salvage covers, evidence markers, a notebook.

Lecture outline

1. Why cause matters: prevention, prosecution and insurance.
2. Origin versus cause.
3. Fire patterns: V-patterns, lowest burn, char depth.
4. Signs to report: multiple origins, trailers, containers, forced entry, unusual odors.
5. What firefighters notice on arrival: people, vehicles, doors and windows, color of smoke.
6. Protecting evidence: leave it in place, cover it, tape off the area, and control who enters.
7. Who investigates: the local or county fire marshal, the State Fire Marshal's Office, law enforcement, and insurance investigators.
8. Writing down what you saw, when, and who you told.

Drill. Trainees find and protect evidence in a staged room, then brief the "investigator".

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for moving or shoveling debris before the origin is checked, and failing to note who entered the scene.

Firefighter II — Modules 22–24

Module 22 — Vehicle extrication and rescue support

Tasks: 2.9–2.11 · **SFFMA:** FF II #12, #13 · **Time:** 3 hr class, 8 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can size up a vehicle crash, control hazards, stabilize the vehicle, manage glass, and disentangle a victim with hand and power tools as part of a team. They can support technical rescue teams by retrieving tools, setting up barriers and helping as assigned.

Materials. Junk vehicles, step chocks and box cribbing, struts, hydraulic or battery spreader, cutter and ram, glass saw and center punch, hard and soft victim protection, a manikin, the department's rescue equipment.

Lecture outline

1. Scene size-up: traffic, fuel leaks, fire, number of vehicles and patients.
2. Vehicle hazards: undeployed airbags (keep clear of their deployment zones), seat-belt pretensioners, high-strength steel, and hybrid and electric vehicles. Never cut the orange high-voltage cables.
3. Power down: park, ignition off, key fob well away, and disconnect the 12-volt battery.
4. Stabilization: chocks, cribbing and struts for vehicles upright, on their side or on the roof.
5. Glass: tempered versus laminated; protecting the patient first.
6. Access and disentanglement: door removal, roof removal, dash lift or roll.
7. Tool safety: pinch points, tool reaction, and never placing your body between the tool and the vehicle.
8. Working with EMS on patient packaging and removal.
9. Technical rescue support: rope, trench, confined space, structural collapse and water. A Firefighter II supports from outside the hazard and does not enter without that training.

Drill stations

- **A. Stabilization:** a vehicle upright and one on its side.
- **B. Glass and access:** remove side and rear glass; pop a door.
- **C. Disentanglement:** full roof removal and a dash lift with a manikin inside.
- **D. Rescue support:** set up a barrier and retrieve tools on request during a mock trench or water rescue.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for cutting before the vehicle is stabilized, standing in an airbag's deployment zone, and no protection for the patient during glass work.

Instructor notes. Floodwater rescues are common in the region; stress that rescuers do not enter moving water without swiftwater training and equipment.

Module 23 — Fire and life safety and preincident planning

Tasks: 2.12–2.14 · **SFFMA:** FF II #7, #9, #11 · **Time:** 3 hr class, 3 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can perform a fire safety survey in an occupied home, give recommendations and refer unresolved problems, present fire safety information to a small group, and prepare a preincident plan with an accurate sketch.

Materials. Home safety survey forms, smoke alarm handouts, prepared presentation materials, preincident plan forms, graph paper or tablet, a district building to survey.

Lecture outline

1. Why prevention is the best way to cut fire deaths.
2. Home safety survey: get permission, walk through with the occupant, check smoke alarms in each bedroom, outside sleeping areas and on every level, heating clearances, cords, dryers, escape routes.
3. Making recommendations without lecturing, and referring problems to the fire marshal.
4. Presentations: know the audience, use prepared materials, keep it short, answer or refer questions, and document it.
5. Core public messages: working smoke alarms, a home escape plan, and stop, drop and roll.
6. Preincident planning: why it saves time and lives.
7. What to record: construction, occupancy, contents, fire protection systems, utilities, hazards and access.
8. Rural water: the nearest static sources and tanker access.
9. Sketching the site and building with standard symbols.

Drill stations

- **A. Safety survey:** survey a member's or volunteer's home with at least two staged hazards.
- **B. Presentation:** give a 10-minute talk to classmates acting as station visitors.
- **C. Preincident plan:** survey and sketch a commercial or agricultural building in the district.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for incomplete forms, missed hazards, and sketches without water supply, utilities or access marked.

Module 24 — Power equipment and hose testing

Tasks: 2.15–2.16 · **SFFMA:** FF II #8, #10 · **Time:** 1 hr class, 3 hr drill

Objectives. The trainee can clean, maintain and run power plants, power tools and lighting equipment to the manufacturer's instructions and record the work. They can perform an annual service test on fire hose, remove failed hose from service, and record the results.

Materials. Generator, saws, positive-pressure fan, extrication power unit, fuel and oil, manufacturer manuals, maintenance log; a hose testing machine or engine with a hose test valve, test lengths of hose, a marker, a timer, record sheets.

Lecture outline

1. Power equipment: check fuel and oil, clean filters, inspect blades and chains, run-test, record.
2. Battery tools: charging, battery care, and storage.
3. Annual hose service testing per NFPA 1930 (formerly NFPA 1962): why hose is tested and what the stenciled test pressure means.
4. Test setup: lay out hose straight and no longer than the test-length limit, fill slowly, bleed all air.
5. Mark the hose behind each coupling to detect slippage.
6. Raise pressure gradually to the service test pressure and hold for the required time.
7. Stand clear: never straddle or stand at the ends of hose under pressure.
8. Fail and remove hose that leaks, bulges or shows coupling slippage; record every length's result.

Drill stations

- **A. Power equipment:** service and run each unit; fill in the log.
- **B. Hose test:** test several lengths of attack and supply hose and complete the record.

Evaluation and common errors. Watch for leaving air in the hose, standing in line with couplings, raising pressure too fast, and missing records.

Instructor notes. Look up the department's hose test pressures and hold times in the current standard before the drill, and use a hose test gate valve rather than pump pressure alone.

Evaluation and remediation

A trainee passes a module when its written quiz is at 70% or better and every task in it is signed at P. That mirrors SFFMA's 70% written passing score, so trainees practice to the same bar they will face.

Written checks

- A short quiz after each module (10–25 questions) drawn from the lecture outline.
- A cumulative practice exam at the end of Firefighter I and of Firefighter II, about 100 questions, timed at 2 hours to match the SFFMA exam.
- Score below 70%: review the missed areas with the trainee and retest on a different day with different questions.

Practical evaluation (P sign-off)

- The trainee performs the task alone, in full PPE, without coaching or prompts, on a different day from the D sign-off.
- The evaluator uses the taskbook's performance standard and the matching SFFMA sheet as the checklist.
- Any safety failure — such as an exposed face or neck in IDLH, an unarmed PASS, an unsecured ladder, or the facepiece removed — is an automatic fail regardless of the rest.
- Hold a mock SFFMA skills day before the real exam: random sheets, an evaluator the trainee does not train with, and no prompts.

Remediation

1. Note the failed attempt in the taskbook's remarks table: what went wrong and the coaching given.
2. Schedule focused practice with a mentor before the retest.
3. After two failed attempts on the same task, the training officer meets with the trainee and mentor to set a written plan and timeline.
4. A trainee with an unresolved safety concern does not ride interior until the training officer clears it.

Records

- Keep a drill roster for every session: date, instructors, safety officer, trainees, topics, hours, taskbook items signed.
- The training officer reconciles rosters with each trainee's taskbook monthly.

- When a phase is complete, upload training records to the SFFMA Portal so the trainee shows eligible for the written exam.

Instructor references and sources

Lesson content follows the job performance requirements in NFPA 1010 (2024) and the SFFMA testing sheets; instructors should teach from a current textbook alongside these lesson plans.

Recommended textbooks (pick one series and stay with it)

- IFSTA, *Essentials of Fire Fighting*, 8th edition (Firefighter I and Firefighter II volumes), aligned to NFPA 1010 (2024).
- Jones & Bartlett / NFPA / IAFC, *Fundamentals of Firefighter Skills and Hazardous Materials Response*, 5th edition, aligned to NFPA 1010 (2024).
- IFSTA, *Hazardous Materials for First Responders*, 6th edition, for the NFPA 470 Awareness and Operations course.

Standards and department documents

- NFPA 1010 (2024), 470, 1400 (2026), 1550, 1580 (2025), 1850 (2025), 1970 (2025), 1140, 2500, 1930.
- GSVFD SOPs, the GSVFD Firefighter Taskbook, and its SFFMA crosswalk.
- UL Fire Safety Research Institute online courses on fire dynamics and flow path.

Sources

- SFFMA — Firefighter I Testing Skills (NFPA 1001-2019)
- SFFMA — Firefighter II Testing Skills (NFPA 1001-2019)
- SFFMA — Written Exams
- Oregon DPSST — NFPA 1010 Firefighter I Task Book (JPR wording)
- Oregon DPSST — NFPA 1010 Firefighter II Task Book (JPR wording)
- Oregon DPSST — NFPA 1010 Firefighter Guide (live-fire prerequisites)
- IFSTA — Essentials of Fire Fighting, 8th Edition
- Fire Safety Council — NFPA 1400 (2026) consolidation
- NFPA 1580 (2025) consolidation
- Consolidated standards list (NFPA 1020, 1550, 2500)